8.1 Introduction

Community development is a professional discipline that brings sustainable development, provides economic opportunity, rights,equality and social justice, promotes education and empowerment of people with their skills within their communities, creates identity or interest in urban and rural settings".

The United Nations defines **community development** as "a process where community members come together to take collective action and generate solutions to common problems. Community development practitioners work along side people in communities to help build relationships with people to identify common concerns.



The Community Development Programmes are based on the following principles:

1. Planning programmes and developmental activities by involving the people to fulfill the various needs of the community.
2. Bringing psychological betterment of the individual.
3. Creating the local leadership and developing socialism.
4. Creating awareness about national policies and political setup in democracy.
5. Setting up of cooperative societies for carrying developmental works.

The Community Development programme is focused on selected areas such as rain water harvesting, water safety, waste management, organic food and organic farming, use of medicinal plants to cure common ailments, protecting the rights of a girl child and various Income generating schemes.

8.2 Rain Water Harvesting

Water is a precious natural resource that needs to be managed and used wisely. Rainwater has nearly neutral pH, and is free from disinfection by products, salts, minerals and other natural, manmade contaminants. The time, duration and the amount of rainfall varies from place to place. With rising population the demand for water is increasing day by day. Modern lifestyle demands more amount of water. This leads to shortage of water in many parts of the country. Hence water must be conserved for future use. One method of conserving water is to collect rainwater and store it for later use. This is called rain water harvesting.



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